MOHAMMED ZAHED HOSSAIN

Business Development Leader | Education Go-To-Market | Generative AI and EdTech

London | 07743 726785 | zaslinks@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/zahedzaslinks | github.com/zahedbri | ycc-navigator.com

PERSONAL PROFILE

Business development leader with 22 years of commercial experience and over 10 years building go-to-market channels in global education across the UK, South Asia, the Middle East and Asia-Pacific. Has worked directly with university leadership, education agents, training providers and government-sponsored programmes, and represented institutions in the UK, China, Malaysia and the USA. Combines this education-sector depth with hands-on generative AI product work: designs and ships AI-powered student advisory, eligibility and lead-management tools built on the Claude API (Anthropic), and works within a software company delivering CRM, HR and web platforms to education clients. Background in software engineering and ERP, MBA in Marketing, and certified in AI (Accenture; Minca Ventures). Seeking to help education customers turn generative AI into new products and measurable outcomes.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Go-to-market strategy:** education segment GTM, market entry, partner and channel co-sell
- **Senior stakeholder engagement:** university leadership, institution owners, agents, government-backed initiatives
- **Generative AI applications:** LLM-based assistants, prompt and workflow design, AI-assisted eligibility and document tools (Claude API)
- **Data and technology:** CRM and lead pipelines, React/Next.js, Supabase, serverless functions; learning AWS (S3, CloudFront, Lambda, API Gateway)
- **Innovation workshops and events:** seminars, education fairs, executive briefings and one-to-many sessions
- **Commercial leadership:** KPI design, forecasting, pipeline reporting, contract negotiation, teams of up to 20

GENERATIVE AI AND EDTECH PROJECTS

- **YCC Navigator (ycc-navigator.com):** generative AI student advisory assistant built on the Claude API. Answers course, fee and entry-requirement questions using web search restricted to official university and UCAS sources, guides students through CV building, Statement of Purpose drafting and CAS interview practice, and hands unresolved enquiries to a CRM.
- **Admission Compliance Ledger:** AI-assisted eligibility tool that assesses applicants against 13 compliance criteria (React + Vite, serverless API proxy). Now being deployed on AWS as a hands-on cloud project (S3/CloudFront hosting, Lambda and API Gateway proxy, Secrets Manager).
- **Lead Desk:** lead-triage application for paid social campaigns generating applicant enquiries from Nigeria, Ghana, Bangladesh and Congo: CSV import, status tracking and automated document-request emails.
- **Commission CRM and The Academic City:** Next.js and Supabase platforms for university–agent–student commission tracking and an online business school demo for senior management.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Business Development Executive

Riz & Rim Solutions Ltd, London (EdTech: web, CRM and HR software for education businesses) | May 2024 – Present

- Lead client engagement for education-sector technology projects, scoping web application, CRM and HR software requirements with education providers and agencies (including Gunjon Education and Global Edulink) and coordinating handoff to the engineering team.
- Translate client business priorities into solution proposals, then manage delivery follow-up and digital marketing for live client platforms.
- Designed and ran CRM-driven marketing campaigns that increased qualified leads by 25% and improved conversion tracking and follow-up.
- Build and manage B2B partnerships with UK and overseas institutions and partner agencies, opening new recruitment and revenue channels.
- Carry out competitor and market analysis to inform programme launches, pricing and positioning; represent the company at international education events.

Business Development Manager – Bangladesh and Nepal

ABE Global UK (UK awarding body) | February 2024 – April 2024

- Led regional go-to-market for a UK awarding body across training institutes and private universities in two countries, opening new territory within two months.
- Negotiated agreements with partner institutions, agents and senior stakeholders to accelerate market penetration.
- Delivered one-to-many seminars and briefings for institution leaders, counsellors and prospective students.

Head of International Recruitment
Zaslinks Study Group | March 2019 – February 2024

- Owned multi-country recruitment strategy and a team of around 10, growing annual student intake by 30% over five years.
- Built and managed partnerships with universities and colleges in the UK, Australia and Canada, and scaled a partner network of more than 25 agents.
- Introduced KPIs across the pipeline and used performance data to make recommendations to leadership, improving forecasting accuracy and accountability.
- Developed digital marketing strategies that increased brand visibility and engagement by 40%.
- Represented the organisation at international education fairs and government-sponsored initiatives.

Country Head – Operations and Business Development
Zain Global (UK) Ltd | January 2016 – December 2018

- Ran country-level operations with more than 20 staff, securing new B2B and distribution partnerships.
- Designed and delivered marketing strategies that increased client acquisition by 35%.
- Managed cross-functional programmes between the UK head office and South Asian teams, aligning processes and timelines to group targets.
- Led negotiations for multi-destination education programmes and institutional alliances.

Earlier Career
Middle East and South Asia

Marketing and business development roles in trade fair consultancy, manufacturing, cargo shipping and oil trading, and financial services in the Middle East, followed by investment consultancy for garment manufacturing in Bangladesh, including ERP technology training.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- MBA, Marketing – Newport University, Bengaluru, India (1999)
- Diplomas in Software Engineering (two) – India, including Enterprise Software Training, Nextgen Software, Delhi; ERP Technology Training
- Organisational Transformation with Artificial Intelligence – Minca Ventures, FutureLearn (2026)
- Digital Skills: Artificial Intelligence – Accenture, FutureLearn (2025)
- British Council and ICEF Certified Education Agent (2020, 2023)

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) | Bengali (Fluent) | Hindi (Proficient) | Arabic (Basic)

References available on request.